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VENTURE



**Brian Singerman is
raising over \$500M for a
new fund with a twist on
the VC model**



Marina Temkin — 4:33 PM PDT · July 14, 2025

Former Founders Fund GP Brian Singerman and co-founder and managing partner of Quiet Capital, Lee Linden, are seeking over \$500 million for a new fund called GPx, three people familiar with their strategy told TechCrunch. A portion of GPx's fund will likely come from Founders Fund co-founder Peter Thiel, these people said.

GPx uses a two-pronged strategy. The firm will invest approximately 20% of its capital into funds managed by emerging VCs, while the remaining pre-seed and seed-stage startup capital will go toward partnerships with emerging managers on leading later-stage investments (most likely at Series B) of their breakout companies.

It's a fairly different approach compared with how most venture firms operate. While typical VC firms invest all of their capital directly into startups, GPx is adopting elements of what's known as a fund-of-funds model, a less common investment strategy where a firm invests some portion of its capital into a portfolio of other funds, rather than directly in underlying assets, such as startups. While a fund-of-funds offers limited partners a convenient way to access under-the-radar or hard-to-access firms, a significant drawback is the dual layer of fees: those charged by the fund-of-funds and those by the underlying managers.

While capital raised by fund-of-funds firms hit a 16-year low last year, [according to PitchBook](#), Singerman and Linden are betting that their

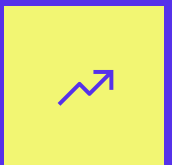
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personal brands, unique networks, and a strategy that's only partially a fund-of-funds will encourage limited partners to open their checkbooks for GPx.

Singerman and Linden may be on to something. As venture capital concentrates in the [largest funds](#), some of those firms' best investors are no longer interested in being a part of a big machine. They are leaving the behemoth firms to launch their own investing outfits where they can be more nimble and specialized.

GPx is betting that the next generation of VC investors will identify and back many strong early-stage companies, allowing Singerman and Linden's firm to co-lead later-stage investments in the emerging managers' most successful portfolio companies.

Here's where GPx's strategy becomes particularly valuable: Early-stage VCs often try to exercise pro-rata rights in later funding rounds (Series A, B, and beyond), but their fund sizes typically prevent them from maintaining their percentage ownership in top-performing companies. When faced with such opportunities, small VCs often scramble to raise special purpose vehicles (SPVs) from their existing limited partners. Yet, these processes are time-consuming, allowing other investors to snap up coveted equity spots in the most sought-after deals.

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top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

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With GPx’s capital behind them, emerging funds will have an opportunity to not only exercise their pro-rata rights but also lead a later-stage round.

The Information [previously reported](#) that Singerman and Linden are launching GPx, but didn’t provide details about the fund’s target size and other strategy details.

Singerman and Linden didn’t respond to a request for comment.

Editor’s note: This story has been updated to reflect Peter Thiel’s involvement with GPx.

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Peter Thiel's Valar Ventures targets \$350M for new funds

Kate Clark — 10:03 AM PST · January 14, 2019

Valar Ventures, one of the three venture funds co-founded by Peter Thiel, has filed paperwork with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission to raise \$350 million across two new funds. The PayPal co-founder and billionaire investor in Facebook and SpaceX is also behind Founders Fund and Mithril Capital Management.

[Valar](#), a New York-based firm, plans to raise [\\$150 million](#) for its fifth flagship venture fund and an additional [\\$200 million](#) for its first opportunity fund, presumably for follow-on investments in its most

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high-growth investments, according to the documents.

Led by general partners Andrew McCormack and James Fitzgerald, Valar tends to invest in financial services companies. Its portfolio includes fintech startups N26, which recently raised a [\\$300 million round](#) at a \$2.6 billion valuation, banking application Even and peer-to-peer currency exchange TransferWise.

Valar closed its debut fund on \$32 million in 2014 and has since set its sights on larger pools of capital. Valar IV, the firm's largest fund yet, brought in [\\$133.4 million in 2018](#). Founders Fund, Thiel's San Francisco venture firm, closed on [more than \\$1 billion](#) for its last effort, and [Mithril](#), his growth equity firm, secured more than \$800 million for its sophomore fund in 2017.

[Banking startup N26 raises \\$300 million at \\$2.7 billion valuation](#)

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Kate Clark was a reporter at TechCrunch covering venture capital and startups.

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Founders Fund confirms \$3 billion in new capital across two funds

Jonathan Shieber — 10:22 AM PST · February 19, 2020

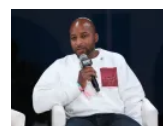
[Founders Fund](#), the investment firm led by its controversial co-founder Peter Thiel and partners Keith Rabois and Brian Singerman, has closed on \$3 billion in new capital across two investment funds, TechCrunch confirmed.

News of the firm's latest fundraising close [was first reported in Axios](#).

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The firm's \$1.2 billion Founders Fund VII closed in December and follows on the heels of a \$1.3 billion Fund VI, which closed in 2016. The firm's first growth fund, which raked in \$1.5 billion, closed on Monday as well, according to a spokesperson for the investment firm. An additional \$300 million in commitments is coming from the firm's partnership to round out the \$3 billion figure.

Fundraising for the new investment vehicles was [first reported in The Wall Street Journal last October](#). And it follows the reunion earlier in 2019 of Rabois and Thiel — two of the most notorious members of the “PayPal mafia” that's produced a number of billionaire entrepreneurs and investors.

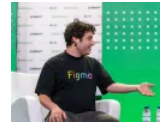
The speed with which Founders Fund has been able to raise new capital is matched by the firm's alacrity in deploying new dollars, according to industry watchers. Rabois in particular has made a splash at Founders Fund since joining the firm — investing large sums in competitive rounds, investors said.

But the firm's success in fundraising is likely due to the returns it has been able to reap for its limited partners. For its 2011-vintage fund four, Founders Fund has more than quadrupled every dollar that the fund committed, to \$4.60, [according to a report in The Wall Street Journal](#) (thanks to investments in Airbnb and Stripe Inc.). That figure compares favorably to the industry average of \$2.11. Meanwhile, the firm's third fund saw its returns increase to \$3.80, 75 cents more than the industry average.

Founders Fund partner Cyan Banister described how the firm's investment practices differ from other venture capital investors in [a wide-ranging interview with TechCrunch last year](#):

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As for how decisions get made, Banister explained that the voting structure is dependent on the size of the check. “So you’d meet with one or two or three or four partners, depending on your [investing] stage,” she told attendees. Because she’s looking at very early-stage startups, for example, she doesn’t have to meet with many people to make a decision. As “dollar amounts gets larger,” she continued, “you’re looking at full GP oversight,” including the involvement of senior members like Brian Singerman and Keith Rabois, and “that can a little more difficult.”

[VC Cyan Banister on who decides what at Founders Fund \(and much more\)](#)

At Axios, Dan Primack reported that the growth fund would write checks of \$100 million at least. The firm’s investment decisions would be structured with any two investment team members agreeing to back deals under \$1.5 million. Any deal above \$1.5 million requires approval from one partner and a general partner; deals above \$5 million require one partner and two general partners; and deals above \$10 million require approvals from two partners and the unanimous approval of Singerman, Thiel and

Rabois. Any deal requiring the approval of the general partners means that the startup that is pitching has to at least talk on the phone or meet in person with the general partners.

Update: This story has been updated to reflect that the firm's Fund VII was \$1.2 billion and its Growth Fund was \$1.5 billion.

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Jonathan was an editor at TechCrunch./p>

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